

Kesha Bagadia

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Technical Designer with 2+ years of experience working with Unity, interdisciplinary research and creative collaboration across 4 shipped games. Passionate about leveraging games and design to incite social change.

SKILLS

Software Experience	Design Processes	Storytelling	Collaboration Tools
Unity(2D/3D), C#, C++ ChatGPT API, OpenXR FMOD Studio, Python, JS, Node.js, MongoDB	Rapid Prototyping Documentation Playtests and Surveys User Research	Branching Dialogue Narrative Systems AI Character Design Improv Acting	Git, Perforce, Unity VCS, JIRA, Notion, Miro, Figma, Adobe Suite, Documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Game Designer **Mic Check Unity3D, uGUI, ChatGPT API** January 2025 – Present
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA (Semester Project)

- Accepted to be presented at **AIIDE 2025**, praised as "very exciting work that is both polished and inventive."
- Designed multiple **emotionally intelligent AI NPCs** with distinct behavior logic and prompt systems.
- Developed **prompt engineering framework** with guardrails, triggers, and contextual response systems.
- Built **dynamic camera, UI and animation systems** for cinematic events and increased game-feel.
- Led **user research** with K-12 and adult audiences to achieve **71% increase in player satisfaction**.

Technical Game Designer **Dear Archibald (Awarded) Discord.js, Node.js, ChatGPT API** January 2025 – May 2025
Center for Transformational Play, Pittsburgh, PA

- Collaborated with lead designer and **AI ethics experts** to implement safe ChatGPT interaction systems.
- Migrated from inflexible third-party system to a custom architecture, enabling **rapid design iteration**.
- Hosted bot live to support A/B testing, achieving **75% increase in player engagement** with design choices.

Technical Game Designer **Educational Game Prototypes Unity2D, uGUI, RenPy** May 2024 – August 2024
Center for Transformational Play, Pittsburgh, PA

- Rapidly prototyped** 5 games and features primarily in Unity to explore **educational game mechanics**.
- Researched and identified **learning pain points** and **popular player styles** with **middle school audiences**.
- Created reusable and modular UI systems that accelerated development across multiple prototypes.
- Collaborated with team using structured feedback processes to support design iteration cycles.

Technical Game Designer **Recollection, Torn Apart (Shipped) Unity3D, OpenXR, FMOD Studio** January 2024 – December 2024
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA (Semester Projects)

- Developed **transformational game design frameworks** with playtesting for target emotional responses
- Led greybox prototyping and leveraged technology affordances to design immersive narrative experiences.
- Designed **story-driven mechanics** and built narrative through community interviews for authenticity.
- Presented at **Play Make Learn, SONA Festival** and **Serious Play**, praised for "empathy-driven design".

Software Engineer Intern **Alice 3 VR Player Unity3D, uGUI, OpenXR** May 2024 – August 2024
The Alice Project, Pittsburgh, PA

- Identified VR usability issues in player application and optimized UI for **accessible user experience**.
- Engineered a **custom Quest VR file transfer system** for Chromebooks to enable easy iterative playtesting.
- Researched competitor brands to refine voice and adapt tone for creative tech and young audiences.
- Facilitated Alice VR classes **to teach K-12 students** interactive storytelling and game development.

K-12 Tutor **PlanetSpark Virtual Platform** April 2023 – August 2023
PlanetSpark, India (Remote)

- Utilized EdTech tools and gamified features to enhance engagement, achieving **+50% student retention**.
- Designed interactive activities** for class participation, receiving reports of increased student confidence.

EDUCATION

Master of Entertainment Technology August 2023 - May 2025
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

GPA: 3.86 / 4.00 | ETC Merit Scholar · CYSTEM Scholar · Jaina Scholar · JITO Scholar

Building Virtual Worlds · Game Design Fundamentals · Visual Story · Supernatural Writing for Screen and Stage

Bachelor of Technology in Information and Communication Technology August 2018 - May 2022
Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, India

GPA: 3.56 / 4.00 | Scholastic Distinction · Dean's List

Machine Learning · Computer Programming & OOP · Data Structures and Algorithms · Linear Algebra · Probability ·

Art of Storytelling and Performance · Human Computer Interaction · Fundamentals of Design · Brain and Behavior